MODULE 01 · WEB

HTML & CSS

A Custom AI-Generated Companion Guide

The building blocks of every website you've ever visited — structure with HTML, style with CSS.

DIGITAL GIRLS INITIATIVE PAKISTAN
Empowering young women through free tech education

6–8 weeks · 4–6 hrs/week

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Welcome & How to Use This Guide

HTML and CSS are the very first languages every web developer learns, and they're the fastest way to see your own code turn into something real on a screen. HTML gives a page its structure and meaning; CSS gives it color, layout, and personality. By the end of this track you'll be able to build and style a complete, responsive website from a blank file.

> **Mentor Tip**
> Type every example yourself instead of copy-pasting. Muscle memory for syntax is what makes the next phase feel easy.

Estimated time: 6–8 weeks · 4–6 hrs/week · Level: No experience needed

01 The Basics

Learn the skeleton of every web page

Start by understanding how a browser reads a document from top to bottom, and how tags describe meaning rather than just appearance.

01 Set up your workspace
Install VS Code and a browser dev-tools habit — you'll live in both.

02 Learn the HTML skeleton
<!DOCTYPE>, <html>, <head>, <body> — understand what each wrapper is for.

03 Master core elements
Headings, paragraphs, lists, links, and images — the 90% you'll use daily.

04 Go semantic
Swap generic s for <header>, <nav>, <main>, <section>, and <footer>.

★ Practice Project

Build a one-page bio: your photo, a heading, two paragraphs about you, and a list of three goals — plain HTML, no styling yet.

02 Styling With CSS

Give your HTML color, type, and rhythm

This phase is where pages start to feel designed. You'll learn how CSS selects elements and how the box model controls every bit of spacing on a page.

01 Selectors & specificity
Target elements by tag, class, and id — and understand which rule wins when two collide.

02 The box model
Content, padding, border, margin — the single most important CSS concept to internalize early.

03 Color & typography
Pick a palette and pair a heading font with a body font, the way this site does.

04 Flexbox for one-dimensional layout
Row and column alignment, spacing, and wrapping — used constantly in real sites.

★ Practice Project

Style a recipe card: image, title, ingredient list, and a styled 'Get Cooking' button, laid out with Flexbox.

03 Layout & Responsive Design

Make it work on every screen

Most visitors to any site you build will be on a phone. This phase teaches you to design for small screens first, then scale up.

01 CSS Grid for two-dimensional layout
Build multi-column page structures — the technique behind most modern homepages.

02 Media queries
Change your layout at defined breakpoints so content reflows instead of breaking.

03 Mobile-first workflow
Style the small screen first, then add rules for larger viewports.

04 Positioning & z-index
Sticky navs, overlays, and layered elements without the layout falling apart.

★ Practice Project

Build a fully responsive portfolio landing page with a hero, a 3-card grid section, and a footer — tested at phone, tablet, and desktop widths.

04 Polish & Ship It

Animation, accessibility, and going live

The final stretch turns a good page into a professional one, and gets it off your laptop and onto the real internet.

01 Transitions & micro-animations

Hover states and smooth transitions that make an interface feel alive without being distracting.

02 Accessibility basics

Alt text, color contrast, and keyboard focus states — designing for every visitor.

03 Cross-browser & device testing

Check your site in at least two browsers and on a real phone before calling it done.

04 Deploy with GitHub Pages

Push your project live with a free, real URL you can put on your CV.

★ Practice Project

Combine everything into one multi-section personal website — home, about, and projects — deployed live with a public link.

Free Video Courses

Curated, highly-rated, and completely free. Pick whichever teaching style fits you best.

> **freeCodeCamp — Responsive Web Design**
> Full certification course, project-based, entirely free
> *https://www.freecodecamp.org/learn/2022/responsive-web-design/*

> **Kevin Powell — CSS Channel**
> The best free teacher for real-world, modern CSS
> *https://www.youtube.com/@KevinPowell*

> **The Net Ninja — HTML & CSS Playlist**
> Short, clear lessons perfect for absolute beginners
> *https://www.youtube.com/@NetNinja*

> **MDN Web Docs — Learn HTML & CSS**
> The official reference every developer keeps open
> *https://developer.mozilla.org/en-US/docs/Learn*

Your Practice Checklist

Print this page or copy it into a notebook. Check off each project as you finish it — real, working projects are what turn this guide into a portfolio.

- [ ] **Phase 01: The Basics — Build a one-page bio: your photo, a heading, two paragraphs about you,**
- [ ] **Phase 02: Styling With CSS — Style a recipe card: image, title, ingredient list, and a styled 'Get**
- [ ] **Phase 03: Layout & Responsive Design — Build a fully responsive portfolio landing page with a hero, a**
- [ ] **Phase 04: Polish & Ship It — Combine everything into one multi-section personal website — home, abo**

Finished all four phases?

Bring your projects to a DG·IP mentor session — we review portfolios and help you plan your next module.

You've got the roadmap.
Now go build something.

This guide is one part of the free DG·IP curriculum. Come back to the website for the live version of this module, curated videos, and seven other free skill tracks.

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